



Sensory marketing

Sensory marketing targets multiple senses to sway purchasing decisions. Based on research showing how the brain responds to sensory input, this type of marketing acts covertly on the customer.

How it works

Sensory marketing is most obviously used by the food and drinks industries, but its use extends to diverse products and services: computers designed with tactile materials, hotels scented to relax customers, and even fireworks displays featuring edible confetti.

Typical channels for sensory marketing include field marketing (in-store events, samples, and person-to-person sales), direct mail, and product delivery. For online businesses, however, finding a way to use it remains a challenge.

Sight

Technology is making advances with this, the most stimulated sense in marketing, by using optical illusions, digital effects, 3-D, and 360-degree photography.



Touch

Marketers use 2-D and 3-D textural print techniques for promotional materials and packaging, as well as to sell products with tactile appeal.



Smell

Customers are willing to pay more for a product sold in an environment that is scented appealingly.



81%
of consumers
born from 1980
to 2000 value
experience over
material items

Taste

Taste sensations can be enhanced or subtly altered by combining them with touch, sight, and especially the closely linked sense of smell.

